

Rogelio Hernandez

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SUMMARY

Backend-focused software engineer with deep expertise in Java, distributed systems, and cloud infrastructure. Proven success architecting scalable, fault-tolerant microservices, leading backend teams, and optimizing high-throughput systems. Known for bridging AI infrastructure with robust backend platforms and delivering latency-sensitive applications at scale.

SKILLS

Languages: Java (expert), Python, C++, Go, SQL

Frameworks: Spring Boot, FastAPI, Kafka Streams, Redis Streams, TensorRT

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (SageMaker, Lambda, ECS, RDS), Kubernetes, Terraform, Docker, Prometheus, Grafana, GitHub Actions

Databases: PostgreSQL (Sharded), Redis, MongoDB, Cassandra

Messaging & APIs: Kafka, gRPC, REST, WebSockets, OAuth2.0, GraphQL

AI/ML Infra: SageMaker, PyTorch, Apache SINGA, TensorFlow, Triton Inference Server

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer

Embodied, Inc.

March 2020 - December 2024, Los Angeles, CA

- Architected and led the development of AI inference microservices using Java (Spring Boot), cutting latency from 120ms to 30ms and scaling daily traffic from 500K to over 10M API requests.
- Designed a real-time Kafka + Redis-powered messaging system, improving system uptime to 99.99% and reducing message delivery lag from 1.2s to 250ms.
- Oversaw a four-region PostgreSQL sharded cluster rollout, increasing geo-distributed query performance by 40%.
- Spearheaded AWS cost optimizations, migrating workloads to ECS and SageMaker, reducing cloud spend by 30%.
- Mentored a 6-person backend team, reviewing system design, performance tuning, and observability practices.
- Owned CI/CD automation using GitHub Actions and Terraform, improving deployment speed by 45%.

AI Infrastructure Engineer

Hugging Face

February 2019 - January 2020, Brooklyn, NY

- Built gRPC + FastAPI APIs for high-throughput NLP model serving, handling 25M+ daily requests with Redis-based embedding reuse.
- Developed serverless model retraining pipelines using AWS Lambda + SageMaker, reducing retraining cycles from 12 hours to under 4 hours.
- Led Java-Python interop initiatives with a gRPC bridge, allowing unified service management across heterogeneous environments.

Distributed Systems Engineer

37signals

September 2017 - December 2018, Chicago, IL

- Designed and deployed Kafka + Redis Streams notification infrastructure handling 10M+ events daily.
- Reduced system latency by 70% by tuning Spring Boot async workflows and implementing backpressure control.
- Implemented autoscaling WebSocket clusters with Kubernetes and achieved 99.98% uptime across all messaging services.

Backend Engineer

Mozilla Foundation

October 2016 - June 2017, Mountain View, CA

- Developed Spring Boot privacy APIs for Firefox, integrating OAuth2.0/JWT auth and handling 1.2M+ tracking requests/day.
- Deployed Redis caching for high-frequency endpoints, reducing API response latency by 50%.
- Managed AWS Lambda deployments for cost-effective API scalability.

Software Engineering Intern

Atlassian

June 2015 - August 2015, San Francisco, CA

- Built internal Java-based CI/CD dashboard using Prometheus metrics, reducing build failures by 25%.
- Integrated Grafana visualizations to increase deployment transparency across 15+ teams.

PROJECT

Contributor - Apache SINGA

github.com/apache/singa

• May 2020 - December 2023

- Built fault-tolerant model training pipelines and CUDA optimizations for large-scale AI training.
- Reduced GPU matrix computation time by 40% and training failure rates by 60%.

Contributor - Dask

github.com/dask/dask

• September 2019 - March 2020

- Optimized serialization and caching backends to improve distributed job execution by 20–35%.

Contributor - Alluxio

github.com/Alluxio/alluxio

• November 2018 – July 2019

- Reduced I/O latency by 45% via Java metadata caching improvements on clustered storage.
- Added Kubernetes auto-scaling logic for dynamic load handling.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Minor in Data Structure and Algorithms • Occidental College • Los Angeles, CA • 2016 • 3.67

- Dean's List: 4 consecutive semesters (2014–2016)
- Teaching Assistant: Data Structures (Spring 2015) – led weekly coding labs and mentored 30+ students
- HackOccidental 2015 Winner: Developed a location-based event app with Python + Flask + MongoDB